



WEEK 3 READING **COMPUTERS TODAY**

From March 03rd to March 09th, 2025

Contents to be developed:

- **Verb To be**
- **Interrogative, negative and affirmative sentences**
- **Wh-Questions**
- **What is a Computer?**
- **Different types of computer**
- **Benefits of laptops and tablet PCs**



VERB TO BE

To be" is one of the most important verbs in English, and it is used to express states of being, existence, identity, or qualities of the subject. In the simple present tense, "to be" has three forms: **AM, IS, and ARE.**

SUBJECT PRONOUN	PRONOMBRE SUJETO
SINGULAR	
I	yo
you	usted
he	él
she	ella
it	*SIN TRADUCCIÓN
PLURAL	
we	nosotros
you	ustedes
they	ellos

The pronoun "I" will always appear in **CAPITAL LETTERS** regardless of whether or not it is at the beginning of the sentence.

"It" as a subject is NEVER translated into SPANISH. As an IMPERSONAL SUBJECT of the verb "TO BE" it is completely omitted. For example:
It is important to study every day. → Es importante estudiar todos los días.

IMPORTANT THINGS TO KEEP IN MIND

YOU: second person singular (tú [INFORMAL] – usted [FORMAL] and second person plural (ustedes)

Tu vs. Tú

Tu

Ejemplos:

- ▶ Donde esta tu libro? (Where is your book?)

Tú

Ejemplos:

- ▶ Tú eres inteligente. (You are intelligent)

○ **You** are a good **student**. / **Tú** eres – **Usted** es un buen estudiante. (**singular**)

○ **You** are good **students**. / **Ustedes** son buenos estudiantes. (**plural**)

○ **THEY:** third person plural

(used for people, things, and animals) For example:

- » The **answers** are correct; **they** are logical.

SPANISH: Las respuestas son correctas; son lógicas.

- » **Those students** are very smart; **they** always get good grades.

SPANISH: Esos estudiantes son muy inteligentes; siempre obtienen buenas calificaciones.

Sentences in Spanish allow for the TACIT SUBJECT. The elliptical, omitted, or tacit subject does not appear explicitly in sentences, although it is often referentially or pragmatically inferable. Thanks to the form of the verb, we understand who we are talking about in the sentence. English, on the other hand, is a language that necessarily requires a subject. THERE IS NO SENTENCE WITHOUT A SUBJECT IN ENGLISH, unless it is an IMPERATIVE.

SUJETO TÁCITO o SUJETO OMITIDO

No aparece, pero podemos deducirlo

Ejemplo:

- **Marcos is my student. He studies English every day.**

TRANSLATION N°1: Marcos es mi estudiante. **Estudia** inglés todos los días.

TRANSLATION N°2: Marcos es mi estudiante. **Él estudia** inglés todos los días.

- **We are very responsible students.**

TRANSLATION N°1: **Nosotros somos** estudiantes muy responsables.

TRANSLATION N°2: **Somos** estudiantes muy responsables.

SUBJECT PRONOUN	VERB TO BE	PRONOMBRE SUJETO	“SER o ESTAR”
SINGULAR		SINGULAR	
I	am	yo	soy / estoy
you	are	usted/ tú	es/ está eres /estás
he	is	él	es /está
she	is	ella	es / está

it	is	-	es / está
PLURAL		PLURAL	
we	are	nosotros/nosotras	somos / estamos
you	are	ustedes	son / están
they	are	ellos/ellas	son / están

I am ...	I' m not ...	Am I...?
You are ...	You' re not ...	Are you...?
He is ...	He' s not ...	Is he...?
She is ...	She' s not ...	Is she...?
They are ...	They' re not ...	Are they...?
We are ...	We' re not ...	Are we...?
It is ...	It' s not ...	Is it...?

1. **AFFIRMATIVE FORM:** Affirmative sentences state something as true or existing. The structure of affirmative sentences with "to be" in the simple present tense is: **SUBJECT + (AM/IS/ARE) + COMPLEMENT.**

- **Examples:**

- I am a software developer."
- She is an expert in cybersecurity.
- They are programmers.
- The new update is available.
- Our computers are fast.
- Some students are lazy.

2. **NEGATIVE FORM:** Negative sentences negate something, indicating that it is not true or does not exist. The structure of negative sentences with "to be" in the simple present tense is: **SUBJECT + (AM/IS/ARE) + NOT + COMPLEMENT.**

- **Examples:**

- I am not a hardware engineer.
- She is not interested in web development.

- They are not software testers.
- The new feature is not user-friendly.
- Our servers are not responsive.

3. INTERROGATIVE FORM: Interrogative sentences ask questions to obtain information. The structure of interrogative sentences with "to be" in the simple present tense is: **(AM/IS/ARE) + SUBJECT + COMPLEMENT + ?**

- **Examples:**

- Am I a computer scientist?
- Is she a network administrator?
- Are they IT consultants?
- Is the software compatible with Windows?
- Are our systems secure?

4. WH-QUESTIONS:

- Wh-questions (questions beginning with who, what, where, when, why, how) seek specific information. The structure of wh-questions with "to be" in the simple present tense is:
 - Wh-word + (am/is/are) + subject + complement + ?
- **Examples related to software and technology:**
 - **What** am I supposed to do as a database administrator?
 - **Where** is the data stored?
 - **When** are the servers scheduled for maintenance?
 - **Why** is the application dangerous?
 - **How** are you today?
 - **How often** are you stressed out?
 - **Who** is your new English teacher?

WH QUESTIONS

Who? What? When? Where? Why?
How? Which? How many? How often?

Wh-words are used to make questions that require information in answer, rather than yes or no.

WHAT?

Used to ask for information.



WHO?

Used to ask about People.



WHEN?

Used to ask for time.



WHERE?

Used to ask for a Place or location.



WHY?

Used to ask for a reason.



WHICH?

Used to ask about choice.



HOW?

Used to ask for way or form.



HOW MANY?

Used to ask about quantity.



HOW OFTEN?

Used to ask about frequency.



PARTS OF A COMPUTER AND THEIR FUNCTIONS

» CPU (Central Processing Unit):

Function: The CPU executes instructions, performs calculations, and coordinates the operations of the computer system. It is the primary component responsible for processing data and running programs.



» MEMORY (RAM - Random Access Memory):

Function: RAM provides temporary storage for data and instructions that the CPU needs to access quickly. It allows the computer to run programs efficiently by storing active data and facilitating fast access.

» **MOTHERBOARD:**

Function: The motherboard is the main circuit board of the computer. It provides connections and interfaces for other components, such as the CPU, RAM, storage drives, and expansion cards, allowing them to communicate with each other.

» **INPUT DEVICES:**

Function: Input devices enable users to enter data and commands into the computer system. They transmit user input to the computer for processing. Examples include keyboards, mice, touchpads, and webcams.

» **OUTPUT DEVICES:**

Function: Output devices display information generated by the computer or produce output in various forms, such as text, images, or sound. They allow users to view and interact with the results of computer operations. Examples include monitors, printers, speakers, and headphones.

» **MOUSE:**

Function: The mouse is an input device that allows users to control the cursor on the computer screen. It enables users to point, click, drag, and scroll, facilitating navigation and interaction with graphical interfaces.

» **KEYBOARD:**

Function: The keyboard is an input device used for typing text, entering commands, and executing shortcuts on the computer. It provides a primary means of communication between the user and the computer.

» **WEBCAM:**

Function: The webcam is an input device that captures video and images in real-time. It enables users to participate in video calls, conferences, and live streaming, as well as to record video content.

» **PRINTER:**

Function: The printer is an output device that produces physical copies of digital documents or images. It allows users to print text, graphics, photos, and other content onto paper or other media.

» **SPEAKER:**

Function: The speaker is an output device that reproduces sound generated by the computer. It allows users to listen to audio files, multimedia content, system alerts, and communication.

» **SCANNER:**

Function: The scanner is an input device that digitizes physical documents, images, or objects into digital formats. It allows users to convert hardcopy documents into electronic files for storage, editing, and sharing.

» **MONITOR:**

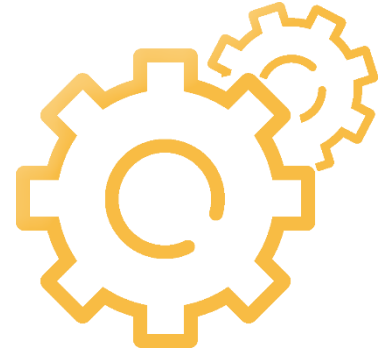
Function: The monitor is an output device that displays visual output from the computer. It provides a visual interface for users to view and interact with digital content, including text, graphics, videos, and applications.

» **HEADPHONES:**

Function: Headphones are output devices that deliver sound directly to the user's ears. They provide a private listening experience and allow users to enjoy audio content without disturbing others.

» **MICROPHONE:**

Function: The microphone is an input device that captures audio input, such as voice or sound, and converts it into digital signals. It enables users to record audio, participate in voice calls, and interact with voice-controlled applications.



These functions outline the roles and capabilities of each component listed, highlighting their importance in the overall functionality of a computer system.

Practice 1: What is a Computer?

Indications: read the following reading and translate the unknown words, then do the activity.

A **computer** is an electronic device that processes data and performs tasks based on a set of instructions called **software**. Computers are used for a variety of purposes, including communication, research, entertainment, and business operations.

The main parts of a computer include the **hardware**, which consists of physical components like the **monitor**, **keyboard**, **mouse**, and **central processing unit (CPU)**. The CPU is often called the "brain" of the computer because it carries out all processing tasks.

A computer also requires **software** to function. There are two main types of software: **system software** and **application software**. The **system software**, such as an **operating system (OS)**, manages the computer's hardware and allows other programs to run. Examples of operating systems include Windows, macOS, and Linux. On the other hand, **application software** includes programs that help users' complete specific tasks, such as word processors, web browsers, and media players.

Computers can be classified into different types, such as **desktop computers**, **laptops**, **tablets**, and **servers**. Each type has different uses, depending on the needs of the user.

With continuous advancements in **technology**, computers have become faster, smaller, and more efficient. They play an essential role in modern society, helping people solve problems and improve productivity in various fields.

Vocabulary Practice: Match the Words with Their Definitions

Instructions: Match each computer-related word with its correct definition.

1. **Computer**
2. **Hardware**
3. **Software**
4. **CPU (Central Processing Unit)**
5. **Operating System (OS)**

6. **Application Software**
7. **Monitor**
8. **Keyboard**
9. **Laptop**
10. **Technology**

Definitions:

- a) A program that allows a computer to run and manage its hardware and software. _____
- b) A device used to input letters, numbers, and commands into a computer. _____
- c) A general term for machines, tools, and systems that help improve daily tasks. _____
- d) The physical parts of a computer, such as the screen, keyboard, and processor. _____
- e) A type of software designed for a specific purpose, like word processing or web browsing. _____
- f) The main processing unit of a computer that executes instructions. _____
- g) An electronic device that processes and stores information. _____
- h) The programs and instructions that tell a computer what to do. _____
- i) A portable computer that can be used anywhere. _____
- j) A screen that displays text, images, and videos from a computer. _____

Practice 2: Complete the Sentences Using the Correct Form of the Verb

"To Be"

Instructions: Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb **"to be"** (**am, is, are**) referring to the computer and its components.

1. A computer ____ an electronic device that processes information.
2. The monitor ____ used to display images and text.
3. The keyboard and mouse ____ input devices.
4. The CPU ____ known as the "brain" of the computer.
5. The operating system ____ necessary for the computer to function.
6. Software programs ____ essential for performing different tasks.
7. A laptop ____ more portable than a desktop computer.
8. The speakers ____ responsible for producing sound from the computer.

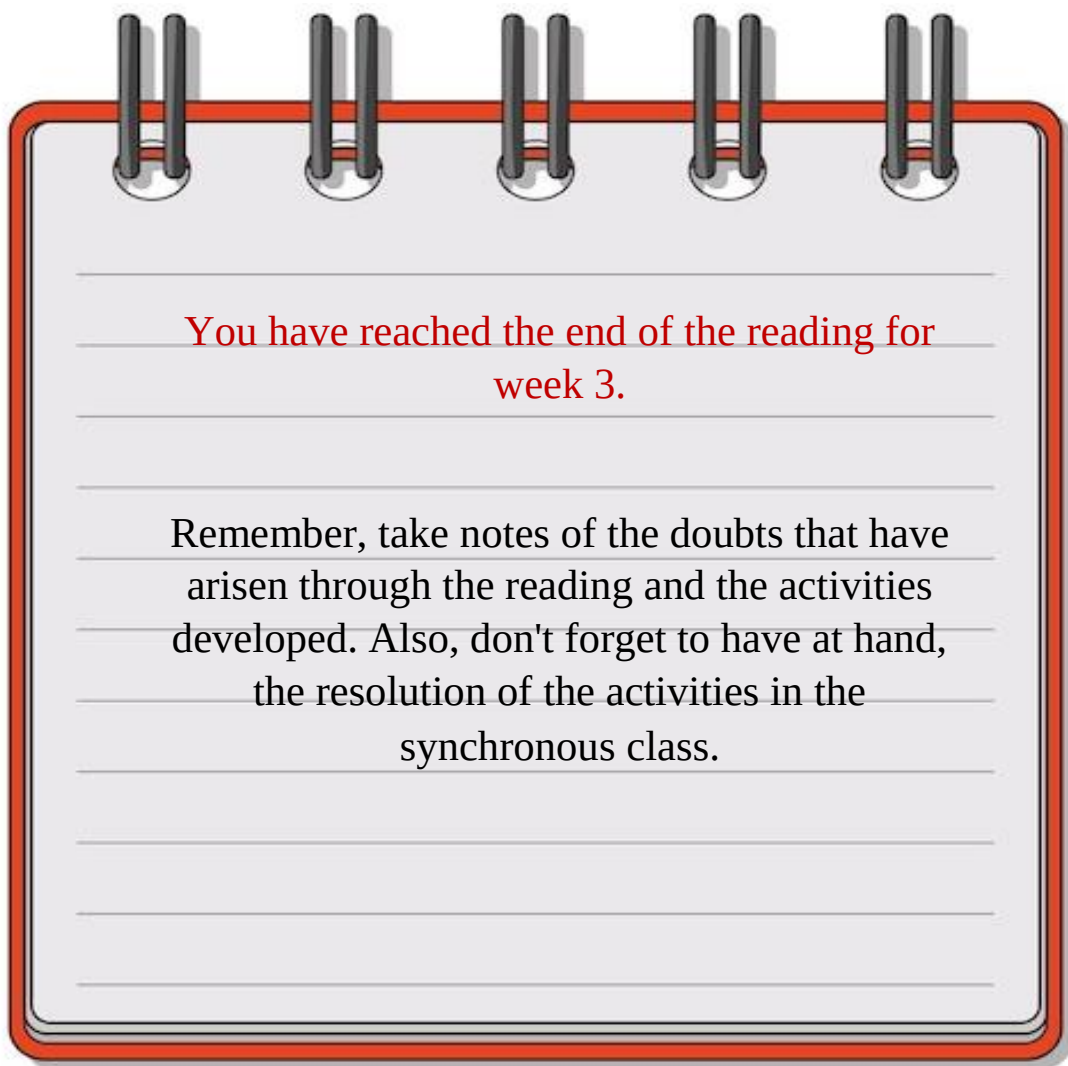
9. My computer ____ very fast because it has a powerful processor.
10. Tablets and smartphones ____ also considered types of computers.

Practice 3: Complete the Sentences Using the Correct Wh-Question

Word

Instructions: Fill in the blanks with the correct **Wh-Question** (What, Where, When, Who, Why, Which, or How) to complete the sentences related to computers.

1. ____ is a computer? → It is an electronic device that processes information.
2. ____ does the CPU do? → It processes all the instructions in a computer.
3. ____ is the operating system needed? → Because it allows the computer to run programs.
4. ____ is responsible for designing software? → Software engineers create and develop software programs.
5. ____ can I find the power button on a desktop computer? → Usually, it is located on the front or top of the CPU case.
6. ____ is the difference between a laptop and a desktop computer? → A laptop is portable, while a desktop is stationary.
7. ____ do I install new software on my computer? → You can download it from the internet or use an installation disk.
8. ____ is the best web browser for security? → Many people consider Google Chrome and Mozilla Firefox to be secure options.
9. ____ does a computer need RAM? → Because it helps store temporary data and improves performance.
10. ____ was the first computer invented? → The first modern computer was developed in the 1940s.



You have reached the end of the reading for
week 3.

Remember, take notes of the doubts that have
arisen through the reading and the activities
developed. Also, don't forget to have at hand,
the resolution of the activities in the
synchronous class.